



A PRINTABLE KIT FOR THE WHOLE FAMILY · AGES 2-5

Play-First Family Kit

Play First, Then Screens. Jobs, then play and time together, then screens at their usual spot. A calm shape for the day, with nothing taken away.



9 printable tools



24 together tokens



Little helping jobs



3-page family plan

30

30-day tracker

Fillable PDF · pre-filled and blank · 4 colorways · Monday and Sunday starts · US Letter and A4 · Color edition

9 tools, one calm rhythm

Organized by age, so you only print what fits your family. Start with the grown-up guide on the next page.



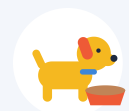
Play First, Then Screens checklists

Ages 2–5 pictures and fillable blanks · 4 colorways
× Mon + Sun
Page 6



The Play-First Board

First, then, later on one page · ages 2–5
Page 22



Little helping jobs

12 picture jobs, pre-filled and blank · ages 2–5
Page 23



Together tokens

12 ready-made + 12 make-your-own
Page 27



Screen-spot cards

5 more minutes, screens go to sleep, what we do next
Page 29



Our Family Play Rules poster

Pre-filled and fillable blank
Page 30



Our Family Play & Screen Plan

3 warm fill-in pages to make together
Page 32



30 Days of Play First

30 no-buy plays with a 3-page guide, plus a blank tracker
Page 35



Play-First Family certificate

A finished-it page to celebrate
Page 40

SECTION A

Grown-up guide, printing and safety
pages 3–5

SECTIONS B–C

Checklists and ages 2–5 tools
pages 6–26

SECTION D

Whole-family tools
pages 27–40

Fillable pages: pages marked “fillable” have type-in boxes that work in free Adobe Acrobat Reader on a computer or phone. You can type names, dates, jobs, rules, token ideas and plan answers. Colors and pictures can't be changed. Every fillable page also prints blank for writing by hand.

Start here, grown-ups

This kit gives your day a simple shape: **jobs first, then play and time together, then screens at their usual spot.** Nothing to take away, only more play to add.



Set up in 2 minutes

- 1** Pick one checklist per child. Pictures for ages 2–5, or the fillable blank. Choose a colorway they like.
- 2** Write in your screen spot. For example, “after dinner”. Keep it the same every day, and the same length.
- 3** Cut the together tokens. Keep them in an envelope. A grown-up keeps the pieces.
- 4** Put it at eye level. Walk through it together once: “First jobs, then we play, then screens.”

Why play first, in plain words

Children practice talking, taking turns and solving problems through back-and-forth: you say something, they answer, you answer back. Jobs, play and meals are full of these turns. Putting them first simply makes more room for them in the day. For ages 1–4, the World Health Organization suggests at least 180 minutes of active play a day (WHO, 2019).

Three talk lines for any page

Pause and wait.

Count to five in your head. Give them a turn to talk, point or sign.

Say what you see.

“You put out the spoons. One, two, three spoons!”

Repeat and add one word.

“Ball.” “Big ball!” “Big red ball!”

Talk, sign, sing and read in the language you know best. Every language counts. A sign, a point or a tap counts as communicating, too. Write your own words, in any language, on the blank pages. You don’t need to be chatty: reading a talk line word for word, or playing quietly side by side, counts too.

How it works at each age

Use what fits: ages are a starting point, and pictures work at any age. Most children love 2 or 3 of these tools; that's normal.

AGES 2-5

Point and say each picture on the checklist. Use the Play-First Board to show first, then, later. Two or three helping jobs a day is plenty.

ALL AGES

Big brothers and sisters can join in: the together tokens, the Family Plan and the rules poster work at any age. Pictures work at any age too.

How screens fit in this kit

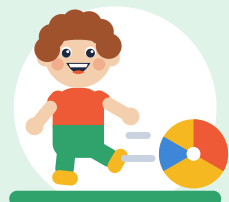
- Screens have a **fixed spot** in the day, the same time and about the same length each day.
- The spot **never grows or shrinks** with jobs or behavior. That keeps screens from becoming the prize, so jobs and play can simply be part of the day.
- **Tokens are for play and time together** (a story, a game, a walk), never screen minutes. Time together is never taken away as a punishment.
- A **talker** (a device a child uses to talk) is their voice, not screen time. It stays with them at meals, in the car and at night.
- **Video calls** with people you love are talk time, not screen time. Wave, show and tell.
- End gently with the screen-spot cards: **5 more minutes**, then **Screens go to sleep**, then **What we do next**.



5 more minutes



Screens go to sleep



What we do next

When stopping is hard

Stay close and name it: "It's hard to stop. You wish it was longer." Then show **What we do next**. Big feelings at the end are normal, and the spot comes back tomorrow.

If interest fades

Move the chart, swap in a fresh token, or fill in a blank checklist for a grown-up; kids love ticking yours. Tired day? Just say the rhythm out loud: "Jobs, play, then screens." That counts.

Every play works from a chair, a bed or a wheelchair. Bring it to a table or tray and let your child do the fetching. Any sound play can be a see-it or feel-it play: a light flick for "stop," a hand on the pot for the beat.

Print it, make it last

About 20 minutes to print and cut, then reusable. The checklists need no cutting: start today.

Printing

- Print at **100% / Actual size**. Don't use "fit to page" for tokens and cards.
- **US Letter** file for the US and Canada; **A4** for everywhere else.
- Charts: regular paper. Tokens, cards and the board: cardstock (65–110 lb / 176–300 gsm).
- The **low-ink file** has white backgrounds and line art children can color.

Make it last

- Laminate the charts and use a dry-erase marker, week after week.
- **No laminator?** Slide charts into clear page protectors. Dry-erase works on those too.
- Laminate tokens before cutting, then cut on the dashed lines, leaving a thin sealed edge.

Hook-and-loop dots: ages 3 and up

- Hook-and-loop dots are small enough to be a choking risk for under-3s.
- **Under 3:** no dots. Lay tokens on top of the board, or slip the board into a page protector and tuck the token inside.
- **Check dots before each play; remove any that lift.**

Shopping list (whole kit, printed once)

- Regular paper: about 10 sheets (the charts you pick)
- Cardstock: 4 sheets (2 token sheets, cards, board)
- 6 laminating pouches, or 6 page protectors
- 1 dry-erase marker · 1 envelope for tokens
- Optional, ages 3+: 12 pairs of hook-and-loop dots

Safety notes

- **Grown-up keeps the pieces.** Every cut piece is 2.1 in (5.3 cm) or larger, bigger than the toilet-paper-tube test for under-3s. Print at 100% so they stay that size, and store them out of reach.
- A grown-up stays close for every play. Water, bubbles and cooking: always within arm's reach. Grown-ups handle knives, heat and glass.
- Every play follows our published safety rules.

Actual size
2.1 in (5.3 cm)

Small-parts size
about 1.25 in

Check your print

After printing the tokens, measure this square. It should be **2.1 in (5.3 cm)** on each side. If it's smaller, your printer shrank the page: print again at 100% / Actual size.

The circle shows the small-parts size for under-3s. Every piece in this kit is much bigger.

Play First, Then Screens

Point to each picture. Say it together. Tick it when it's done.



NAME _____ WEEK OF _____

MONDAY START · TOMATO

Mon Tue Wed Thu Fri Sat Sun

1 Jobs first



Get dressed

☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐


Brush teeth

☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐


Tidy toys

☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐


A helping job

☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

2 Then play and time together



Play outside

☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐


Read together

☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐


Play together

☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

3 Then screens, at their usual spot



Screens, at their spot

after _____ for _____

☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

TALK TIP · SAY WHAT YOU SEE

"Shoes on! You did it all by yourself."

OUR SCREEN SPOT

Our screen spot is the same every day. Jobs and play come first because that's our rhythm, not a race.

Play First, Then Screens

Point to each picture. Say it together. Tick it when it's done.



NAME _____ WEEK OF _____

SUNDAY START · TOMATO

Sun Mon Tue Wed Thu Fri Sat

1 Jobs first



Get dressed

☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐


Brush teeth

☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐


Tidy toys

☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐


A helping job

☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

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NAME _____ WEEK OF _____

MONDAY START · SKY

Mon Tue Wed Thu Fri Sat Sun

1 Jobs first



Get dressed

☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐


Brush teeth

☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐


Tidy toys

☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐


A helping job

☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

2 Then play and time together



Play outside

☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

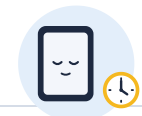

Read together

☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐


Play together

☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

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NAME _____ WEEK OF _____

SUNDAY START · SKY

Sun	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat
-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----

1



Get dressed



Brush teeth



Tidy toys



A helping job



2



Play outside



Read together



Play together



3



Screens, at their spot



“Shoes on! You did it all by yourself.”

Our screen spot is the same every day. Jobs and play come first because that's our rhythm, not a race.

Play First, Then Screens

Point to each picture. Say it together. Tick it when it's done.



NAME _____ WEEK OF _____

MONDAY START · GRASS

Mon Tue Wed Thu Fri Sat Sun

1 Jobs first



Get dressed

☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐


Brush teeth

☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐


Tidy toys

☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐


A helping job

☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

2 Then play and time together



Play outside

☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

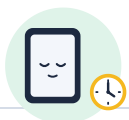

Read together

☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐


Play together

☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

3 Then screens, at their usual spot



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Sun Mon Tue Wed Thu Fri Sat

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MONDAY START · PLUM

Mon Tue Wed Thu Fri Sat Sun

1 Jobs first



Get dressed

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Brush teeth

☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐


Tidy toys

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Play outside

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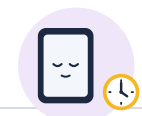

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☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐


Play together

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Sun Mon Tue Wed Thu Fri Sat

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2 Then play and time together



Play outside

☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

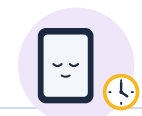

Read together

☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐


Play together

☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

3 Then screens, at their usual spot



Screens, at their spot

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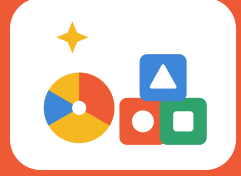
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OUR SCREEN SPOT

Our screen spot is the same every day. Jobs and play come first because that's our rhythm, not a race.

Play First, Then Screens

Type or write your own jobs and play. Draw a picture in each circle.



NAME _____ WEEK OF _____

MONDAY START · TOMATO

Mon Tue Wed Thu Fri Sat Sun

1 Jobs first

draw it							
draw it							
draw it							
draw it							
draw it							

2 Then play and time together

draw it							
draw it							
draw it							
draw it							

3 Then screens, at their usual spot



Screens, at their spot

after _____ for _____

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TALK TIP · REPEAT AND ADD ONE WORD

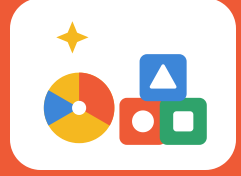
"Ball." "Big ball!" "Big red ball!"

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SUNDAY START · TOMATO

Sun Mon Tue Wed Thu Fri Sat

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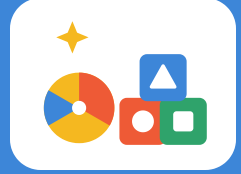
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NAME _____ WEEK OF _____

MONDAY START · SKY

Mon Tue Wed Thu Fri Sat Sun

1 Jobs first

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draw it							

2 Then play and time together

draw it							
draw it							
draw it							
draw it							

3 Then screens, at their usual spot



Screens, at their spot

after _____ for _____

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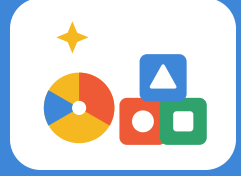
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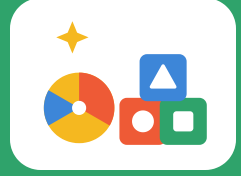
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MONDAY START · GRASS

Mon Tue Wed Thu Fri Sat Sun

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draw it							
draw it							

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Screens, at their spot

after _____ for _____

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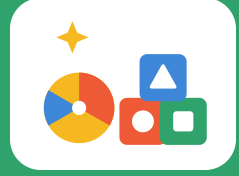
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Screens, at their spot

after _____ for _____

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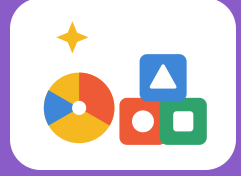
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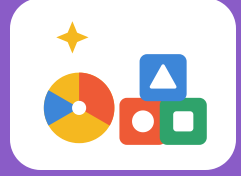
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SUNDAY START · PLUM

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2 Then play and time together

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3 Then screens, at their usual spot



Screens, at their spot

after _____ for _____

--	--	--	--	--	--	--

TALK TIP · REPEAT AND ADD ONE WORD

"Ball." "Big ball!" "Big red ball!"

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Our screen spot is the same every day. Jobs and play come first because that's our rhythm, not a race.

The Play-First Board

First, then, later: the whole idea on one page. Great for little ones who don't read yet.

1

First: jobs

Draw or write today's job, or point to it on your checklist.

draw it

**2**

Then: together time

Lay a together token here (page 27). Under 3? Just lay it on top, with no hook-and-loop dots.



Put a together token here

**3**

Later: screens

Screens come last, at the same spot every day.



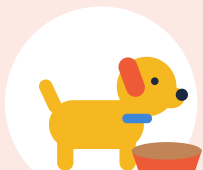
after _____

Little helping jobs

Pick 2 or 3 jobs for this week and color a dot each day you help. Doing it together counts.

NAME _____

WEEK OF _____



Feed the pet

Mo Tu We Th Fr Sa Su



Water plants

Mo Tu We Th Fr Sa Su



Match socks

Mo Tu We Th Fr Sa Su



Wipe a spill

Mo Tu We Th Fr Sa Su



Set the table

Mo Tu We Th Fr Sa Su



Shoes away

Mo Tu We Th Fr Sa Su



Carry a light bag

Mo Tu We Th Fr Sa Su



Recycling

Mo Tu We Th Fr Sa Su



Fold towels

Mo Tu We Th Fr Sa Su



Books back

Mo Tu We Th Fr Sa Su



Tidy toys

Mo Tu We Th Fr Sa Su



Stir and wash

Mo Tu We Th Fr Sa Su

TALK TIP · SAY WHAT YOU SEE

"You're carrying the towels. Soft towels!"

SAFE HELPING

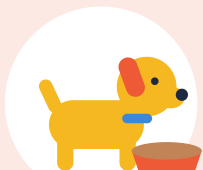
A grown-up stays close. Grown-ups handle knives, heat and glass. Bags stay light.

Little helping jobs

Pick 2 or 3 jobs for this week and color a dot each day you help. Doing it together counts.

NAME _____

WEEK OF _____



Feed the pet

Su Mo Tu We Th Fr Sa



Water plants

Su Mo Tu We Th Fr Sa



Match socks

Su Mo Tu We Th Fr Sa



Wipe a spill

Su Mo Tu We Th Fr Sa



Set the table

Su Mo Tu We Th Fr Sa



Shoes away

Su Mo Tu We Th Fr Sa



Carry a light bag

Su Mo Tu We Th Fr Sa



Recycling

Su Mo Tu We Th Fr Sa



Fold towels

Su Mo Tu We Th Fr Sa



Books back

Su Mo Tu We Th Fr Sa



Tidy toys

Su Mo Tu We Th Fr Sa



Stir and wash

Su Mo Tu We Th Fr Sa

TALK TIP · SAY WHAT YOU SEE

"You're carrying the towels. Soft towels!"

SAFE HELPING

A grown-up stays close. Grown-ups handle knives, heat and glass. Bags stay light.

Our helping jobs

Pick 2 or 3 jobs for this week and color a dot each day you help. Doing it together counts.

NAME _____

WEEK OF _____

draw it Mo Tu We Th Fr Sa Su	draw it Mo Tu We Th Fr Sa Su	draw it Mo Tu We Th Fr Sa Su
draw it Mo Tu We Th Fr Sa Su	draw it Mo Tu We Th Fr Sa Su	draw it Mo Tu We Th Fr Sa Su
draw it Mo Tu We Th Fr Sa Su	draw it Mo Tu We Th Fr Sa Su	draw it Mo Tu We Th Fr Sa Su
draw it Mo Tu We Th Fr Sa Su	draw it Mo Tu We Th Fr Sa Su	draw it Mo Tu We Th Fr Sa Su

TALK TIP · SAY WHAT YOU SEE

"You're carrying the towels. Soft towels!"

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Our helping jobs

Pick 2 or 3 jobs for this week and color a dot each day you help. Doing it together counts.

NAME _____

WEEK OF _____

draw it Su Mo Tu We Th Fr Sa	draw it Su Mo Tu We Th Fr Sa	draw it Su Mo Tu We Th Fr Sa
draw it Su Mo Tu We Th Fr Sa	draw it Su Mo Tu We Th Fr Sa	draw it Su Mo Tu We Th Fr Sa
draw it Su Mo Tu We Th Fr Sa	draw it Su Mo Tu We Th Fr Sa	draw it Su Mo Tu We Th Fr Sa
draw it Su Mo Tu We Th Fr Sa	draw it Su Mo Tu We Th Fr Sa	draw it Su Mo Tu We Th Fr Sa

TALK TIP · SAY WHAT YOU SEE

"You're carrying the towels. Soft towels!"

SAFE HELPING

A grown-up stays close. Grown-ups handle knives, heat and glass. Bags stay light.

Together tokens

Tokens are for play and time together, never screen minutes. After jobs, your child picks one. Grown-up keeps the pieces. Every piece is at least 2.1 in (5.3 cm), bigger than the toilet-paper-tube test. Print at 100%. Hook-and-loop dots are for ages 3+ only: check dots before each play; remove any that lift.



Make-your-own together tokens

Type or write your own ideas for time together, then draw a picture. Grown-up keeps the pieces. Every piece is at least 2.1 in (5.3 cm), bigger than the toilet-paper-tube test. Print at 100%. Hook-and-loop dots are for ages 3+ only: check dots before each play; remove any that lift.

draw it TOGETHER TOKEN	draw it TOGETHER TOKEN	draw it TOGETHER TOKEN
draw it TOGETHER TOKEN	draw it TOGETHER TOKEN	draw it TOGETHER TOKEN
draw it TOGETHER TOKEN	draw it TOGETHER TOKEN	draw it TOGETHER TOKEN
draw it TOGETHER TOKEN	draw it TOGETHER TOKEN	draw it TOGETHER TOKEN

Screen-spot cards

Show what comes next, so screen time starts and ends gently: 5 more minutes, then screens go to sleep, then what we do next.

Grown-up keeps the pieces. Every piece is at least 2.1 in (5.3 cm), bigger than the toilet-paper-tube test. Print at 100%. Hook-and-loop dots are for ages 3+ only: check dots before each play; remove any that lift.



Play first!

Jobs, then play and time together.



Together time

Pick a together token.



Screen spot

Screens come last, after:



5 more minutes

Find a good place to stop.



Screens go to sleep

Say goodnight and put it away.

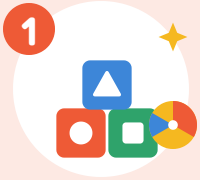


What we do next

Next we will:

Our Family Play Rules

Short, kind and the same for everyone, grown-ups too.



We play first.



Screens have a spot in our day.



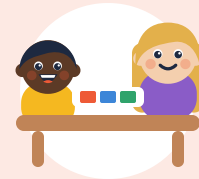
Meals are for being together.



Screens sleep in their spot at night.



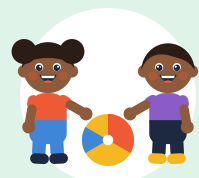
We give a 5-minute heads-up.



Grown-ups play too.



We go outside every day we can.



Anyone can say, "Come play with me!"

Signed by our family _____

Our Family Play Rules

Write your own, together. Short and kind works best.

draw it	draw it
draw it	draw it
draw it	draw it
draw it	draw it

Signed by our family _____

Our Family Play & Screen Plan

Fill this in together, on a calm day. There are no right answers, just what fits your family right now.

This is the plan for the _____ family.

Made on _____ by _____

Our favorite ways to play together

Our play-first rhythm

Morning

First, our jobs:

Then, we play:

After nap

First, our jobs:

Then, we play:

Evening

First, our jobs:

Then, we play:

Our screen spot

Screens have a spot in our day: after _____ for about _____

It stays the same each day. It doesn't grow or shrink with jobs or behavior, so it never becomes the prize.

Where and when screens rest

Pick a few screen-free times and places. Fewer rules, kept kindly, work better than many.

Screens rest...

- | | |
|--|--|
| ☐ At meals | ☐ In bedrooms at night |
| ☐ The hour before bed | ☐ Short car rides |
| ☐ When friends come to play | ☐ While we talk to each other |
| ☐ Other: _____ | |

A talker (a device a child uses to talk) never rests: it's their voice, so it stays with them.

At night, our screens sleep in _____

One set charging spot makes bedtime easier for everyone, grown-ups included.

Watching and playing together

When you can, choose together, watch together, and talk about it after: "Who was your favorite? What would you do?"

Shows, games or videos we enjoy together:

What the guidelines say

- **Ages 1–4:** at least 180 minutes a day of active play, in any mix. No screen time under age 1; no more than 1 hour a day at ages 2–4 (WHO, 2019).
- **Ages 2–5:** about 1 hour a day of high-quality programs, watched together when you can (AAP, 2016).
- **For families:** choose screen-free times and places together, like meals, car rides and bedrooms, and make a family plan (AAP, 2016). For older children, there's no single number; this plan helps you choose what fits.

Sources: World Health Organization, Guidelines on physical activity, sedentary behaviour and sleep for children under 5 years of age (2019). American Academy of Pediatrics, "Media and Young Minds," Pediatrics 2016;138(5). Every family is different; your pediatrician is a good person to ask about your child.

When plans change, and our promises

Sick days, travel and long waits happen. Some days need more screens, and that’s okay. Tomorrow, we go back to our rhythm.

On busy, sick or travel days, our plan is:

Grown-up promises

For example: “I’ll give a 5-minute heads-up.” “I’ll put my screen away at meals too.”

Kid promises

For example: “When the card says ‘Screens go to sleep’, I’ll find a stopping place.”

We’ll look at this plan again on _____

Children grow fast. A plan that fit at 4 will need a new look at 6, and again at 9.

Everyone signs (or draws themselves)

SIGN OR DRAW HERE

SIGN OR DRAW HERE

SIGN OR DRAW HERE

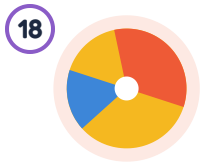
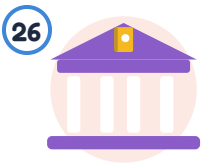
SIGN OR DRAW HERE

SIGN OR DRAW HERE

SIGN OR DRAW HERE

30 Days of Play First

Color a tile each day you play first. Every idea is free, with nothing to buy. Skipped a day? Pick up tomorrow. Each play's age, easier and harder ways and tired-day version: pages 36–38.

 1 Blanket fort	 2 Kitchen dance party	 3 Read a book together	 4 Sock-match race	 5 Spot 5 red things
 6 Draw each other	 7 Cup tower	 8 Puppet show	 9 Bubbles outside	 10 Play restaurant
 11 Hide a toy, give clues	 12 Watch for birds	 13 Cook dinner together	 14 Freeze dance	 15 Build a tall tower
 16 Make up a story	 17 Nature walk	 18 Roll-the-ball game	 19 Sing 3 favorite songs	 20 Game night
 21 Move like animals	 22 Tape roads for cars	 23 Picnic on the floor	 24 Dress-up parade	 25 Garden helper
 26 Library visit	 27 Tea party	 28 Hide and seek	 29 Look at photos of people we love	 30 Pick a favorite, again!

TALK TIP • FOLLOW THEIR LEAD

Let your child pick the order. Their plan, their pride.

SAFETY

A grown-up stays close for every play. Bubbles, water and cooking: within arm's reach.

The 30 plays, made easy

Every play here has a starting age, what you need, and an easier and a harder way. Tired? The 2-minute version still counts. Times are in minutes and only a guess.

PLAY · STARTING AGE	YOU NEED	MAKE IT EASIER	MAKE IT HARDER	TIRED GROWN-UP: 2 MINUTES	SAY
1 Blanket fort From 18 months ⌚ Prep 5 🧼 Mess low ⌚ Play ~20	🛋 Blankets, chairs, pillows Safety: Nothing heavy on top.	Drape one blanket over a table and crawl in.	Add a door, a sign and a reading corner.	Throw a blanket over you both and whisper.	"In or out? You choose."
2 Kitchen dance party From 12 months ⌚ Prep 0 🧼 Mess none ⌚ Play ~10	🎵 Music	Hold them and sway together.	Each makes up a move; everyone copies.	One song, everyone dances.	"Fast or slow?"
3 Read a book together From 6 months ⌚ Prep 0 🧼 Mess none ⌚ Play ~10	📖 Any book	Point to the pictures and name them.	They read a page to you, or guess what happens next.	One short book, or one page.	"What do you see?"
4 Sock-match race From 24 months ⌚ Prep 1 🧼 Mess low ⌚ Play ~10	🧦 Clean socks	Find the one sock that matches mine.	Sort by color, then by size.	Match 5 pairs.	"Same or different?"
5 Spot 5 red things From 24 months ⌚ Prep 0 🧼 Mess none ⌚ Play ~10	🚫 Nothing	Find one red thing.	New color, or 5 things that start with "b".	Look out one window together.	"Red! What else is red?"
6 Draw each other From 30 months ⌚ Prep 1 🧼 Mess low ⌚ Play ~15	📄 Paper, crayons or pencils Safety: Under 3: chunky crayons, grown-up close.	Scribble together on one big page.	Draw each other from memory, then compare.	One quick face each.	"Tell me about your picture."
7 Cup tower From 12 months ⌚ Prep 0 🧼 Mess none ⌚ Play ~10	🍵 Plastic or paper cups Safety: Never glass.	Stack 3 cups, then knock them down.	Build a pyramid of 10 and count as you go.	One tower, one crash.	"Up, up... crash!"
8 Puppet show From 24 months ⌚ Prep 2 🧼 Mess low ⌚ Play ~15	🧦 A sock or paper bag Safety: Under 3: no buttons or stick-on eyes.	The puppet says hi, hides and pops out.	Put on a show with a start, middle and end.	Your hand says hello in a silly voice.	"What does the puppet want?"
9 Bubbles outside From 12 months ⌚ Prep 3 🧼 Mess some ⌚ Play ~15	🧼 Dish soap, water, a wand Safety: A grown-up holds the bottle. Not for drinking.	You blow, they pop.	Try giant bubbles, or count before they pop.	Ten bubbles on the doorstep.	"Pop! Big or small?"
10 Play restaurant From 30 months ⌚ Prep 2 🧼 Mess low ⌚ Play ~20	🍴 Pots, spoons, paper	Serve one pretend cup of soup.	Write a menu, take orders, bring the bill.	"One pretend pizza, please!"	"What would you like?"

SAFETY FOR EVERY PLAY

A grown-up stays close. Under 3: nothing smaller than a toilet-paper tube, and no whole grapes, nuts, popcorn or hard candy. No balloons for under-8s. No cords or long scarves around necks. Water and bubbles: always within arm's reach.

The 30 plays, continued

Plays 11–20. Use the age as a starting point; your child can try any play with you close by.

PLAY · STARTING AGE	YOU NEED	MAKE IT EASIER	MAKE IT HARDER	TIRED GROWN-UP: 2 MINUTES	SAY
11 Hide a toy, give clues From 24 months 🕒 Prep 0 🧴 Mess none 🕒 Play ~10	📦 One toy Safety: Under 3: a toy bigger than a toilet-paper tube.	Hide it with a bit still showing.	Give “warmer, colder” clues, or written clues.	One hide, one find.	“Is it under or behind?”
12 Watch for birds From 18 months 🕒 Prep 0 🧴 Mess none 🕒 Play ~10	📦 A window or yard	Point and say “bird!”	Count them, draw one, or sort by color.	Look out the window together.	“Where is it going?”
13 Cook dinner together From 24 months 🕒 Prep 0 🧴 Mess some 🕒 Play ~20	📦 Tonight’s dinner Safety: Grown-ups handle knives, heat and glass.	Wash vegetables or tear lettuce.	Measure, stir and read the next step.	One job: stir or pour.	“What comes next?”
14 Freeze dance From 24 months 🕒 Prep 0 🧴 Mess none 🕒 Play ~10	📦 Music	Hold hands; stop when the music stops.	Freeze in a shape: tall, tiny, an animal.	One song.	“Dance... and freeze!”
15 Build a tall tower From 12 months 🕒 Prep 0 🧴 Mess low 🕒 Play ~15	📦 Blocks, boxes or cups Safety: Under 3: blocks bigger than a toilet-paper tube.	Stack 2 or 3, then knock down.	Taller than your knee? Add a bridge.	Five blocks, then crash.	“Up! More! Down!”
16 Make up a story From 36 months 🕒 Prep 0 🧴 Mess none 🕒 Play ~10	📦 Nothing	You tell it; they add one word: “A dog!”	Take turns, one sentence each.	Three lines each, starting “Once...”	“And then what?”
17 Nature walk From 12 months 🕒 Prep 2 🧴 Mess low 🕒 Play ~20	📦 Shoes Safety: Nothing from outside goes in mouths.	Stroll and name what you see.	Collect 5 things and make a map.	Walk to the corner and back.	“Look! What’s that?”
18 Roll-the-ball game From 9 months 🕒 Prep 0 🧴 Mess none 🕒 Play ~10	📦 A soft ball	Sit facing each other and roll it back and forth.	Knock down cup “pins”, or count catches.	Ten rolls.	“Ready, set... roll!”
19 Sing 3 favorite songs From 6 months 🕒 Prep 0 🧴 Mess none 🕒 Play ~10	📦 Nothing	One song with hand moves.	Change the words or add a new verse.	One song.	Pause before the last word and let them fill it in.
20 Game night From 36 months 🕒 Prep 2 🧴 Mess low 🕒 Play ~20	📦 Any game or a deck of cards Safety: Keep small game pieces away from under-3s.	Play “I spy” or a matching game.	Let them teach you the rules.	Three rounds of rock, paper, scissors.	“Your turn, my turn.”

SAFETY FOR EVERY PLAY

A grown-up stays close. Under 3: nothing smaller than a toilet-paper tube, and no whole grapes, nuts, popcorn or hard candy. No balloons for under-8s. No cords or long scarves around necks. Water and bubbles: always within arm’s reach.

The 30 plays, continued

Plays 21–30. Use the age as a starting point; your child can try any play with you close by.

PLAY · STARTING AGE	YOU NEED	MAKE IT EASIER	MAKE IT HARDER	TIRED GROWN-UP: 2 MINUTES	SAY
21 Move like animals From 18 months 🕒 Prep 0 🍷 Mess none 🕒 Play ~10	📦 Some space	Stomp like an elephant together.	Act out an animal; the others guess.	Three animals across the room.	"How does a frog move?"
22 Tape roads for cars From 24 months 🕒 Prep 5 🍷 Mess low 🕒 Play ~20	📦 Painter's tape, toy cars Safety: A grown-up holds the tape. Under 3: cars bigger than a toilet-paper tube.	One straight road on the floor.	Add bridges, parking spots and a map.	One road on the table.	"Where is the car going?"
23 Picnic on the floor From 12 months 🕒 Prep 5 🍷 Mess some 🕒 Play ~20	📦 A blanket and a snack Safety: Sit to eat. Under 4: no whole grapes, nuts, popcorn or hard candy.	Snack on a blanket.	Plan the menu and pack a basket.	One snack on a towel.	"What shall we bring?"
24 Dress-up parade From 24 months 🕒 Prep 2 🍷 Mess low 🕒 Play ~20	📦 Old clothes and hats Safety: No cords, ties or long scarves around necks.	One hat each; look in the mirror.	Make up a character with its own voice.	One hat, one walk across the room.	"Who are you today?"
25 Garden helper From 24 months 🕒 Prep 1 🍷 Mess some 🕒 Play ~10	📦 A plant, a cup of water Safety: Wash hands after. Soil and stones stay out of mouths.	Water one plant together.	Plant a seed and measure it each week.	Water one plant.	"Is it thirsty?"
26 Library visit From 6 months 🕒 Prep 5 🍷 Mess none 🕒 Play ~45	📦 A free library card	Pick one book together.	They choose and check out their own books.	At home, "visit" your shelf and pick one.	"This one or that one?"
27 Tea party From 18 months 🕒 Prep 1 🍷 Mess low 🕒 Play ~15	📦 Cups, a toy or two Safety: Pretend or cool water only.	Pretend to pour: "Mmm!"	Invite the toys, set places, serve courses.	One pretend cup each.	"More tea?"
28 Hide and seek From 18 months 🕒 Prep 0 🍷 Mess none 🕒 Play ~15	📦 Nothing Safety: Agree on no-hide places: no dryers, chests or cars.	Peekaboo behind a door or blanket.	They count to 20 and do the seeking.	One hide, one seek.	"Where are you?"
29 Look at photos of people we love From 12 months 🕒 Prep 1 🍷 Mess none 🕒 Play ~10	📦 Printed photos or an album	Find the faces: "Who's that?" Photos from now are just as good.	Tell the story behind one photo.	One photo, one story.	"What were they doing?"
30 Pick a favorite, again! From 12 months 🕒 Prep 0 🍷 Mess low 🕒 Play ~15	📦 Whatever the play needs	Pick the shortest favorite.	Make it bigger than last time.	Any 2-minute version on these pages.	"Which one? Why that one?"

SAFETY FOR EVERY PLAY

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30 Days of Play First

Write your own 30 plays, then color a tile each day you play first.

1 draw it	2 draw it	3 draw it	4 draw it	5 draw it
6 draw it	7 draw it	8 draw it	9 draw it	10 draw it
11 draw it	12 draw it	13 draw it	14 draw it	15 draw it
16 draw it	17 draw it	18 draw it	19 draw it	20 draw it
21 draw it	22 draw it	23 draw it	24 draw it	25 draw it
26 draw it	27 draw it	28 draw it	29 draw it	30 draw it

TALK TIP • FOLLOW THEIR LEAD

Let your child pick the order. Their plan, their pride.

SAFETY

A grown-up stays close for every play. Bubbles, water and cooking: within arm's reach.



Play Before Pixels

CERTIFICATE

Play-First Family

This is to celebrate

for **30 days of playing first**, together.



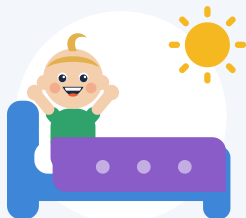
Date _____

Our favorite play _____

Snap a photo for the fridge, or for the grandparents.

Next for your family

Same calm design and the same “talk while you play” idea. Find them all at playbeforepixels.com.



181 Visual Routine Cards

AGES 0-5

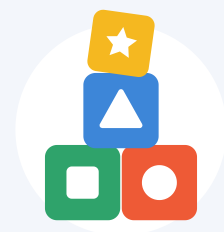
Picture cards for mornings, meals, bath and bedtime.



76 “I’m Bored” Play Cards

AGES 1-5

Pick-a-card play ideas, each with a talk line.



Toddler Busy Book

AGES 1-5

74 paper-and-play activities, sorted by age, with a talk line on every page.



52 Play & Talk Cards

AGES 0-5

One simple play and one talk tip on every card.



YOUR FREE BONUS

Scan for free companion printables

- A summer and holiday Play First, Then Screens checklist
- 12 extra together tokens for rainy days
- One short play idea a month, matched to your child’s age

playbeforepixels.com/bonus/play-first-family-kit

We ask for an email and, if you like, your child’s birth month and year so ideas fit their age. Never names. Unsubscribe anytime. Need your files again? Your link stays in your order email; help is at playbeforepixels.com/help.